BSU-IACUC Web Portal User Manual

For Reviewers

Benguet State University, Cordillera Center for Animal Research and Development (CCARD)

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I. About this manual

This manual explains how to use the BSU-IACUC portal as a reviewer. It follows the order in which most reviewers use the system: creating an account, checking the protocol inbox, verifying a training certificate, commenting on a protocol, and finishing the review.

The portal is run by the Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC) under CCARD. A protocol is the written plan, filled out on the official IACUC form, that describes how a researcher will use live animals in their research. As a reviewer, you are the first stage of the process. You read each submitted protocol, mark problems directly on the document, and then either send the protocol back to the researcher or mark it as reviewed.

Once a protocol is Reviewed, administrative staff take over the remaining steps: payment, the IPN, the signed scan, endorsement and the clearance. You do not need to do anything for those steps, and this manual does not cover them.

II. Before you start

Prepare the following before you create your account.

1. An invitation link from CCARD administrative staff. Reviewer accounts cannot be created from the public Register page. Each link works for 48 hours, so ask for a new one if yours has expired.
2. An email address you can open right now. The portal sends a verification link to it and uses it to tell you when a protocol needs your attention.
3. A computer or tablet, if you can. The portal also works on a phone, but drawing comment boxes on a document is easier on a larger screen.

Only reviewers can add comments and return protocols for revision. Administrative staff can open the same protocols but cannot review them. Reviewers cannot verify payments, assign IPNs, endorse protocols or manage clearances, because those steps belong to administrative staff.

The portal works in any current browser on a computer, tablet or phone.

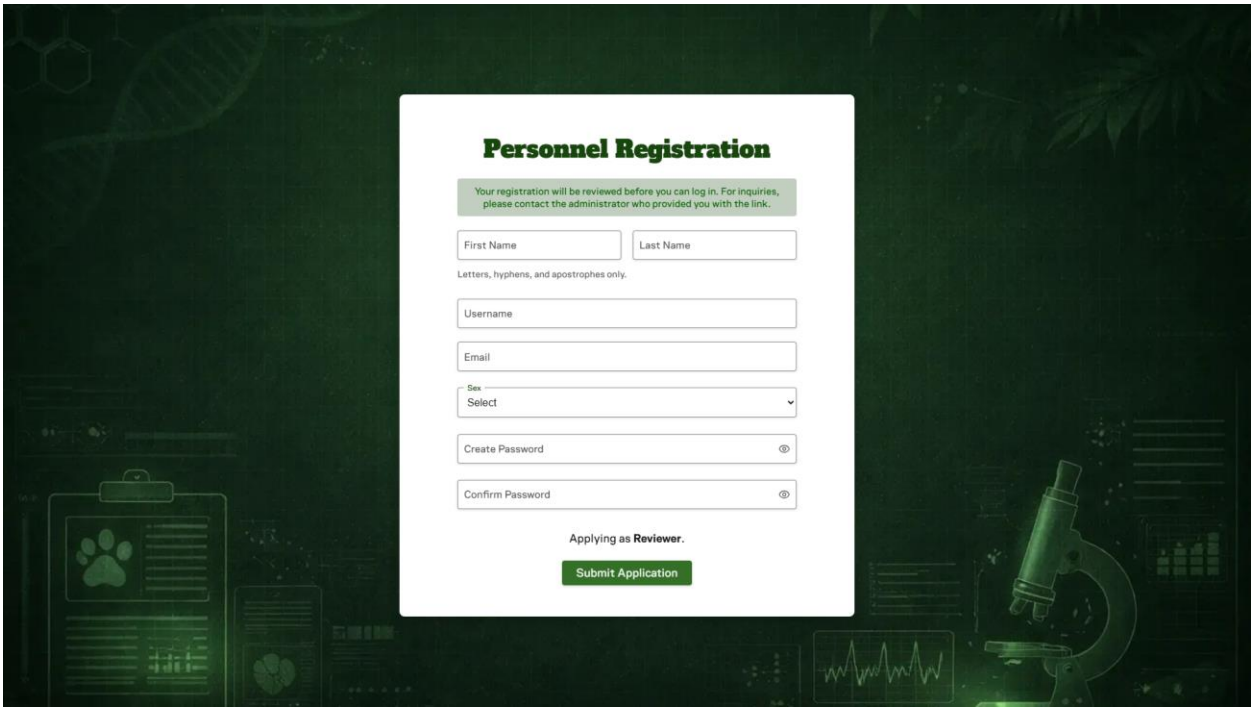
III. Creating an account

1. Open the invitation link you received. The Personnel Registration page opens and shows the role you are applying as. It should say Reviewer.
2. Fill in the form. Every field is required.

Field	***What to enter***
First name, Last name	Letters, spaces, hyphens and apostrophes only, at least 2 characters each
Username	3 to 50 characters. Letters, numbers, underscores and hyphens only
Email	A valid address you can open
Sex	Male or Female

Create Password	At least 8 characters, with an uppercase letter, a lowercase letter, a number and a special character
Confirm Password	Type the same password again

3. Press Submit Application.



Your account is not active yet. Administrative staff must approve your application first, and you will be notified by email once it has been reviewed. You cannot log in until then.

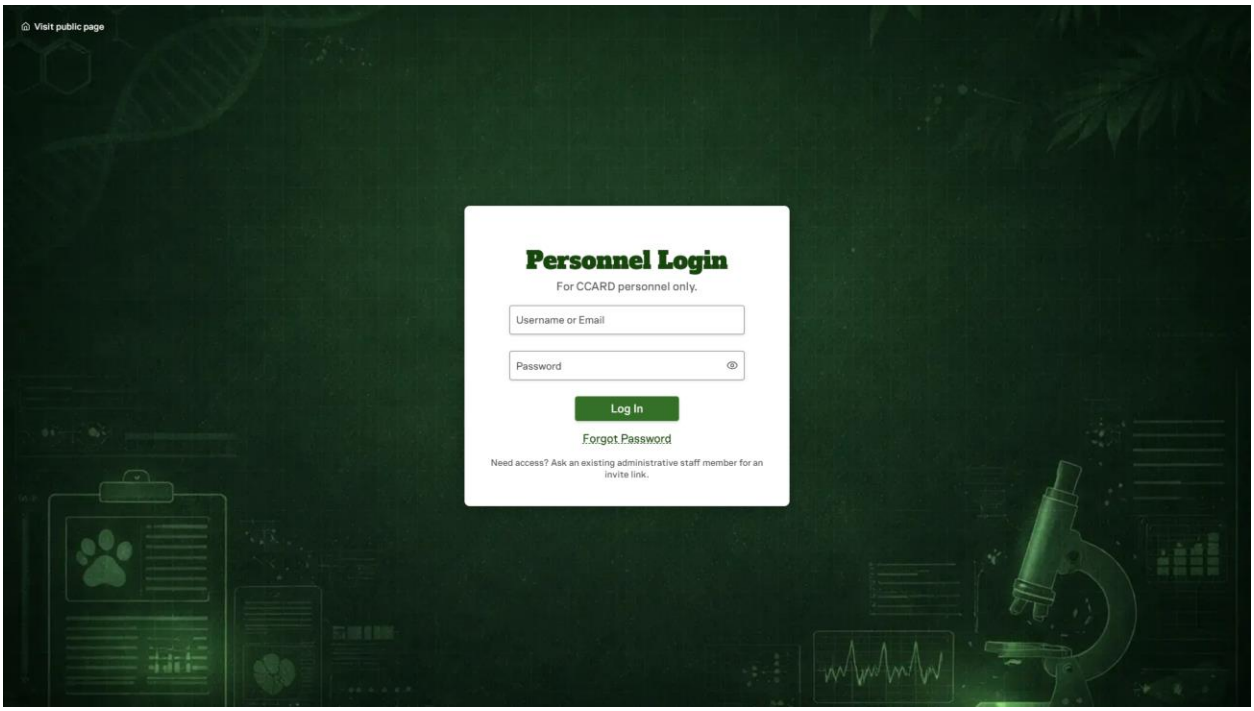
Verifying your email

You can log in before your email is verified, but the portal keeps reminding you until it is done. Press Verify email in My Account to get a verification link, then open the link to confirm the address. On the reminder, press Remind me later to hide it for one hour.

If the email does not arrive, check your spam folder and request a new link from My Account. If you change your email address later, you will need to verify the new one.

IV. Logging in and out

Open the Personnel Login page. Its address is the portal address followed by /personnel/login (https://iacuc.infinityfree.me/portal/personnel/login) , and CCARD administrative staff can send you the link. Enter your username or email and your password, then press Log In. After a successful login you land on the Dashboard.



A few things to know:

- If your account has not been approved yet, the portal tells you that it is pending administrative staff approval.
- Five wrong attempts within 15 minutes lock the login for 15 minutes. Wait, then try again.
- If you forget your password, press Forgot Password, enter your email and open the reset link we send. Choose a new password that meets the same rules as above. If the link has expired, request a new one from the same page.
- For your protection, the portal signs you out after 30 minutes without activity. A warning appears about two minutes before this happens. Press the button in the warning to stay signed in.
- Log out from the account menu at the top right when you are using a shared computer.

Inactive accounts

Your account is deactivated automatically when you have not logged in for 6 months. Administrative staff can also deactivate an account. A deactivated account cannot log in, and you cannot reactivate it yourself. Contact CCARD administrative staff and ask them to reactivate it.

V. Finding your way around

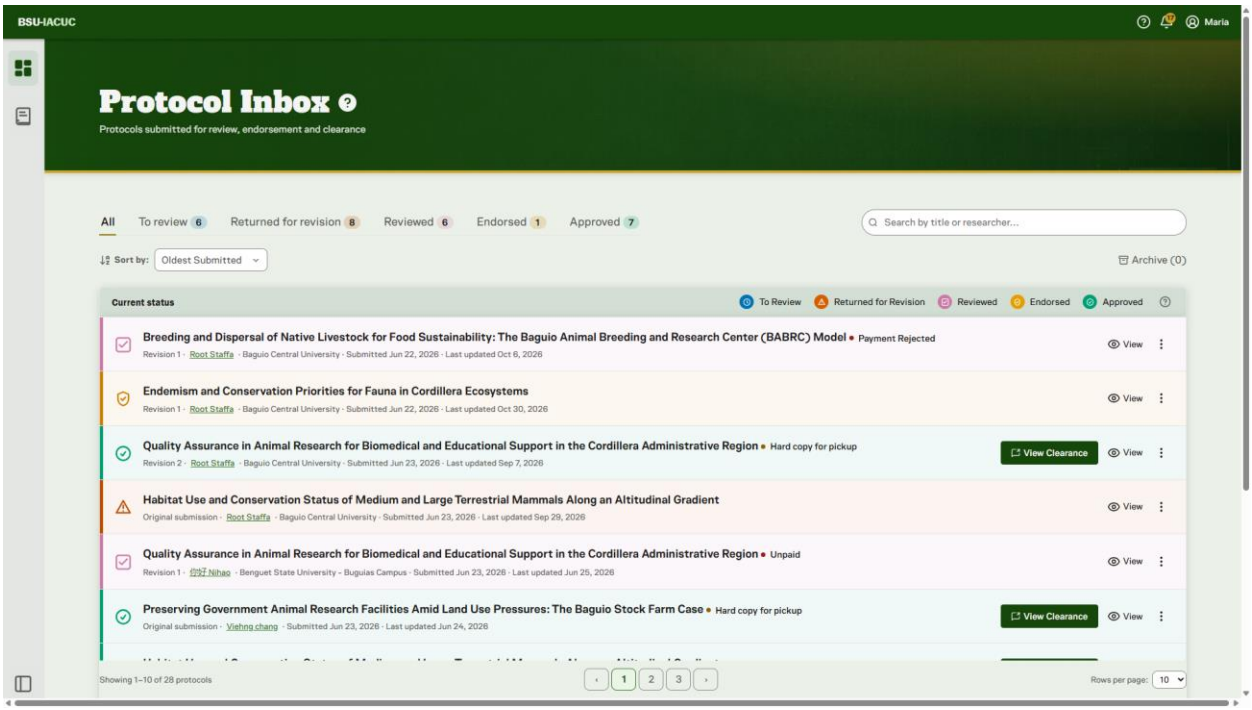
The menu

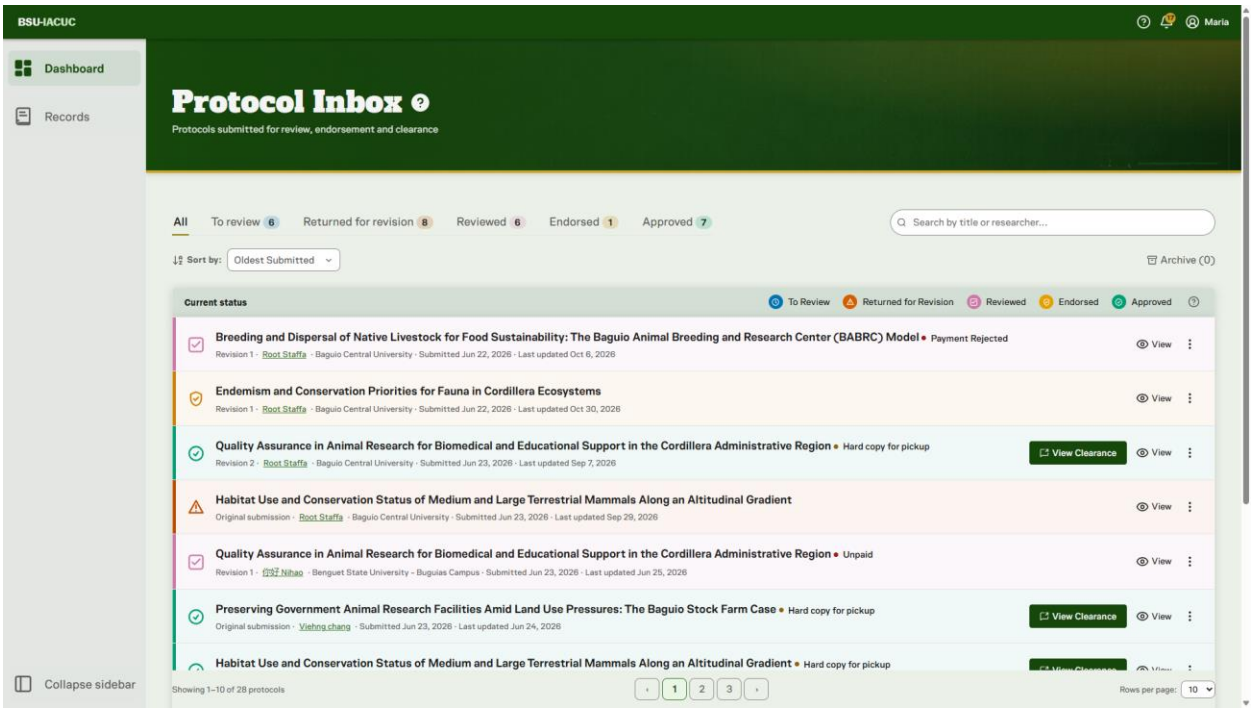
The icon bar on the left side of the page (the menu button on a phone) has two pages.

Page	*What it is for*

Dashboard	The protocol inbox. This is where you will spend most of your time
Records	The table of all protocol records, with a Statistics tab

Press the Expand sidebar button at the bottom of the bar to show the page names next to the icons.





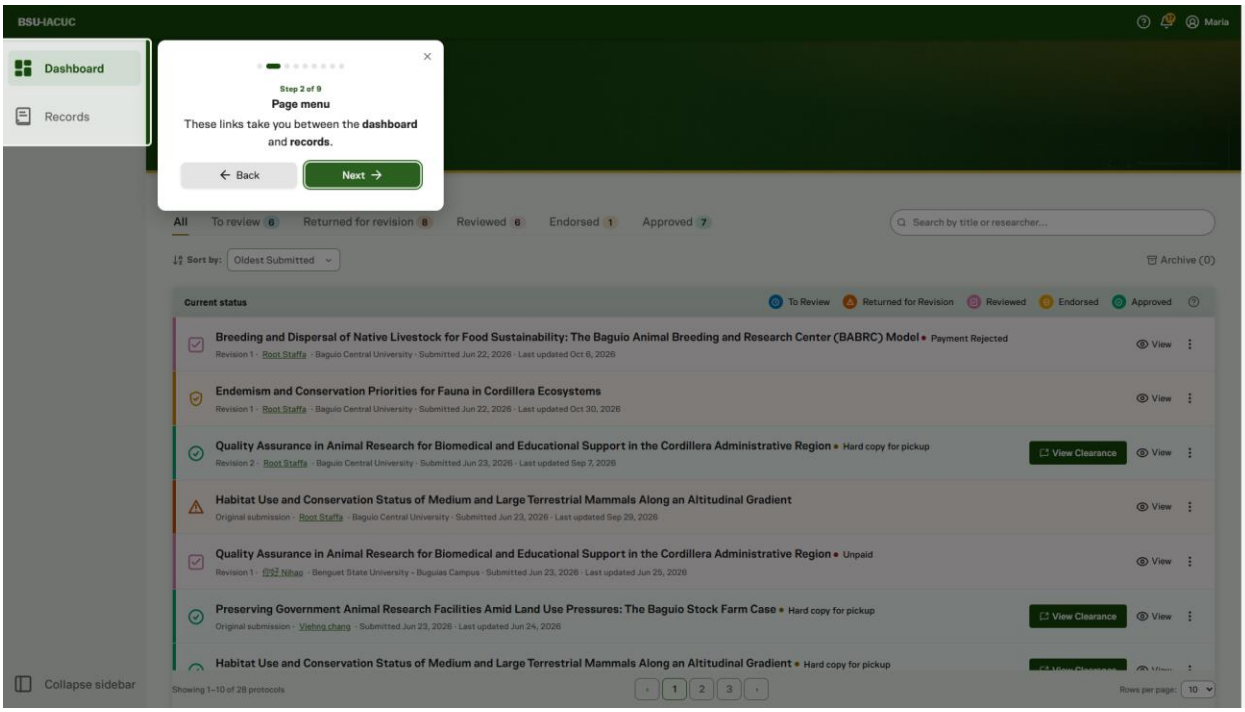
The top bar

The top bar holds the Guide button, the notification bell, and My Account. A small Offline tag appears beside the logo when your device has lost its connection (see section XIII).



Built-in guides

The portal can walk you through itself. The first time you log in, a short tour starts automatically and explains your role as a reviewer. Press the Guide button in the top bar to replay it. Most pages also have a small question mark button next to the page title or tab that opens a tour of that page. Use Next and Back to move through a tour, or press Enter to go forward.



Light and dark theme

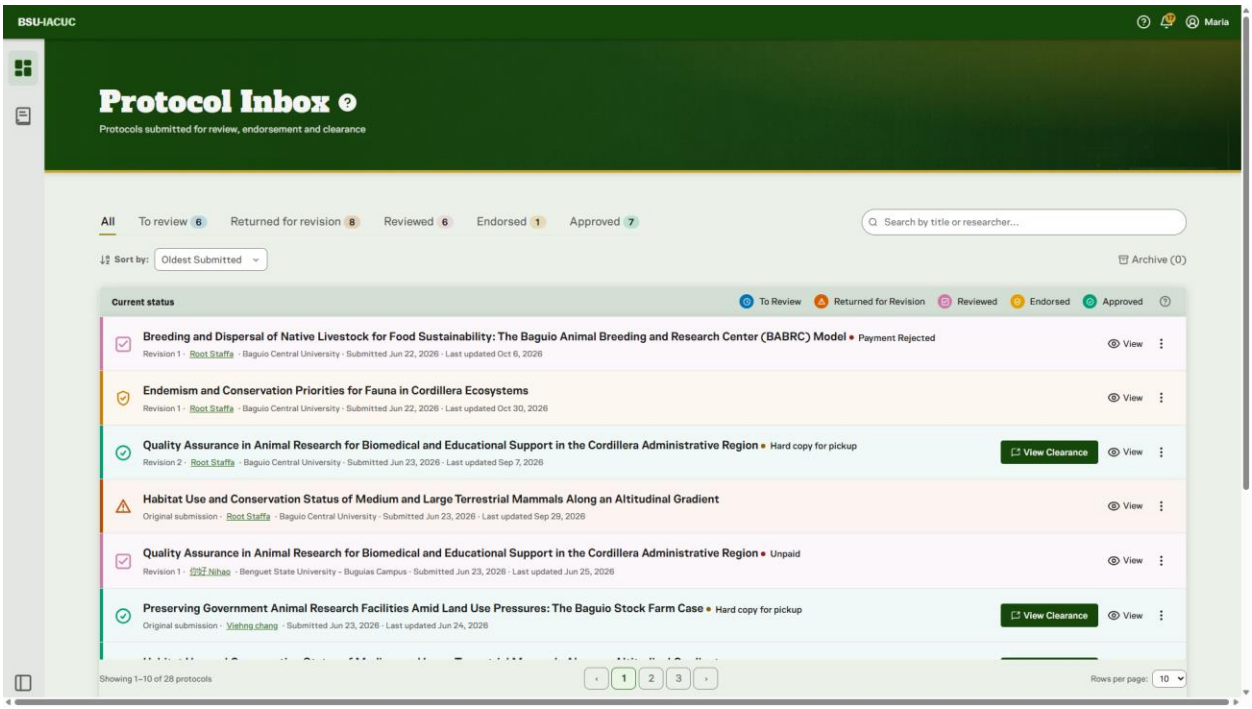
Open My Account and choose light, dark or system. System follows your device setting.

Previewing the public site

Open My Account and press Preview public site to see the Home, Announcements and Contact Us pages as researchers see them. It opens in a new tab and is marked Preview.

VI. The Dashboard

The Dashboard lists every protocol submitted to CCARD. It is where you pick the next protocol to review.



- Search finds a protocol by its title or by the researcher's name.
- Status filters at the top narrow the list to one status. The number beside each name is how many protocols have that status.
- Sort changes the order: newest or oldest submitted, recently updated, or by title.
- The status legend shows the color and icon of each status. Press the question mark at the end of the bar to read what each status means.
- Archive holds approved protocols of researchers whose accounts are inactive. They are kept out of the other tabs and move back to Approved when the researcher reactivates their account.
- Each card is one protocol. It shows the status icon, the title, the submission round, the researcher's name and school, the date submitted and the date last updated.
- Press a researcher's name on a card to see their contact details and the status of their training certificate.
- The bar at the bottom lets you move between pages and choose how many protocols to show per page.

The main button on a card depends on its status. On a To Review card it is Review. On an Approved card it is View Clearance, with View Protocol beside it. On every other card it is View Protocol. The three-dot menu holds the other actions (section XI).

VII. What each status means

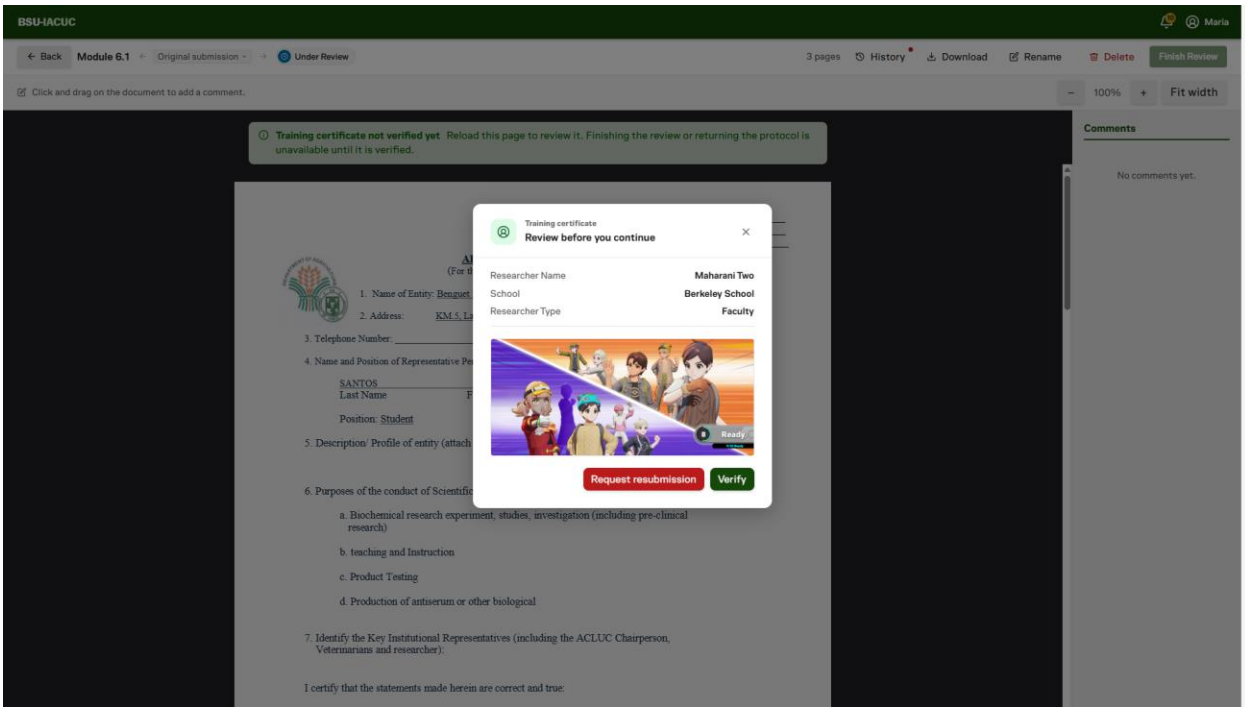
Status	*What it means*	*What you do*
To Review	The protocol is waiting for your feedback. If it is the researcher's first submission, their training certificate is also waiting to be verified.	Press Review. Verify the certificate first when it is pending (section VIII).
Returned for Revision	You sent the protocol back to the researcher with feedback.	Nothing. Wait for the researcher to resubmit. You are notified when they do.
Reviewed	You finished the review. Administrative staff now verify payment, assign the IPN and upload the signed scan.	Nothing. You can undo the review until payment is verified (section XI).
Endorsed	The protocol was endorsed to the Department of Agriculture, Regional Field Office, Cordillera Administrative Region (DA-RFO-CAR).	Nothing. Administrative staff handle the clearance.
Approved	The animal research clearance has been issued.	Nothing. Press View Clearance to see it.

The Dashboard calls the first status To Review. Inside the protocol viewer, the same status is called Under Review.

VIII. Verifying a training certificate

A researcher's first submission comes with their IACUC training certificate. You cannot finish the review or return the protocol until the certificate is verified. Any reviewer or administrative staff member can verify it, and whoever decides first settles it for everyone.

When you open a protocol whose certificate is pending, a window opens automatically. It shows the researcher's name, school and role, with a preview of the certificate. You can also open it from the Dashboard by pressing the researcher's name on a card.



1. Check that the certificate is readable, complete and current, and that the name matches the researcher.
2. If it is acceptable, press Verify and confirm.
3. If it is not, press Request resubmission, type the reason (required, up to 500 characters), and press Send request.

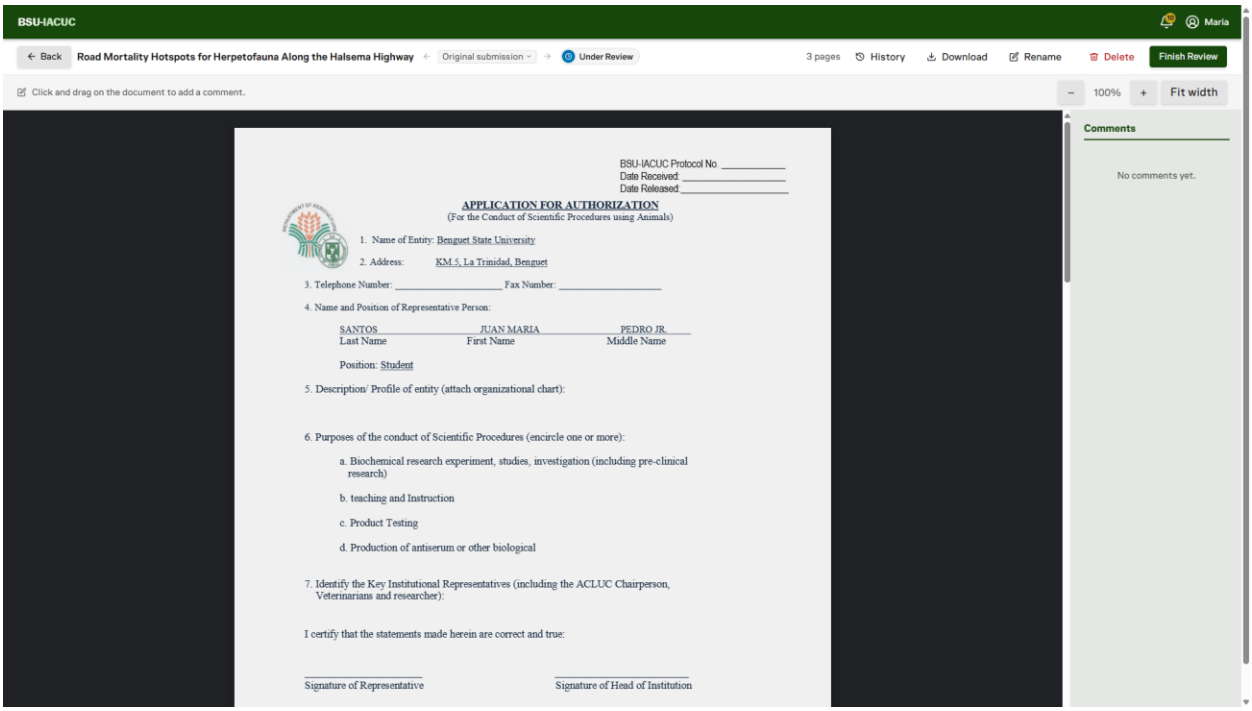
The researcher is notified of your decision. After a resubmission request, you can still read and comment on the protocol, and your comments are saved, but Finish Review stays unavailable until a new certificate has been verified. You are notified when the researcher resubmits it.

You can close the window with the X and decide later. Reload the page to open it again.

IX. Reviewing a protocol

Opening a protocol

Press Review on a To Review card. The protocol opens in the viewer.



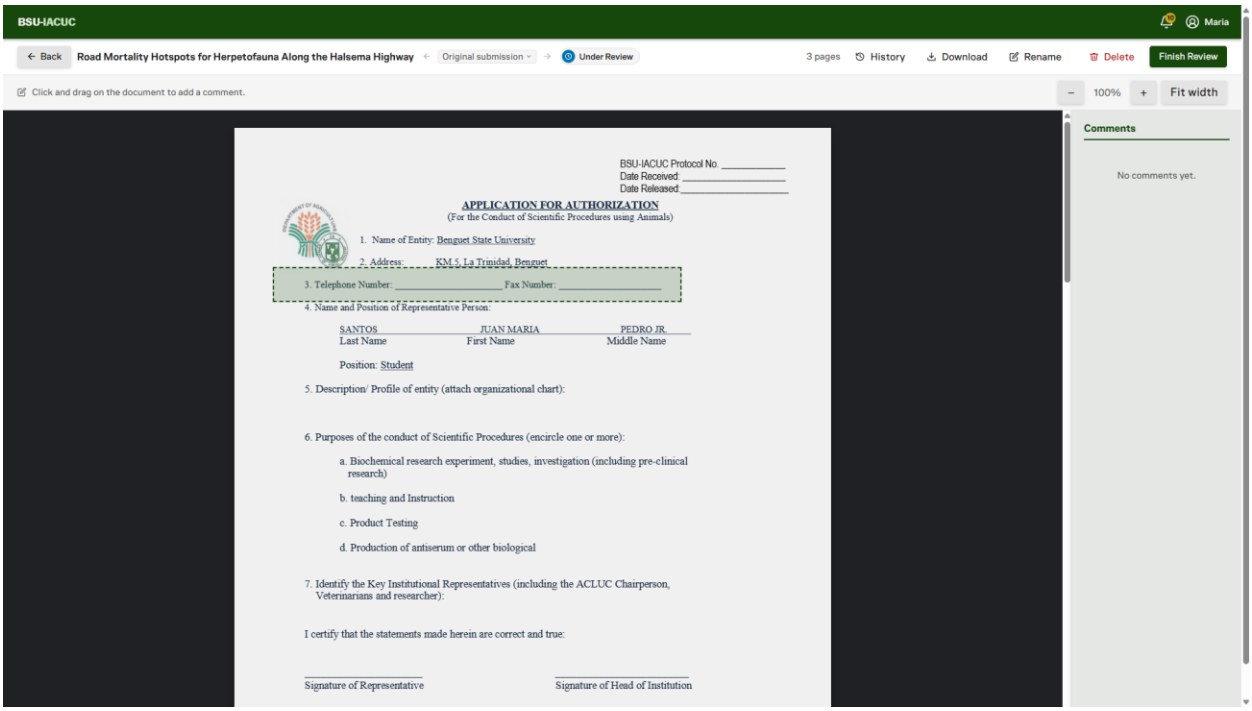
The top bar shows the Back button, the protocol title (press it to read the full title), the status, the version, the More menu and the Finish Review button. The document is in the middle, and the Comments panel is on the side.

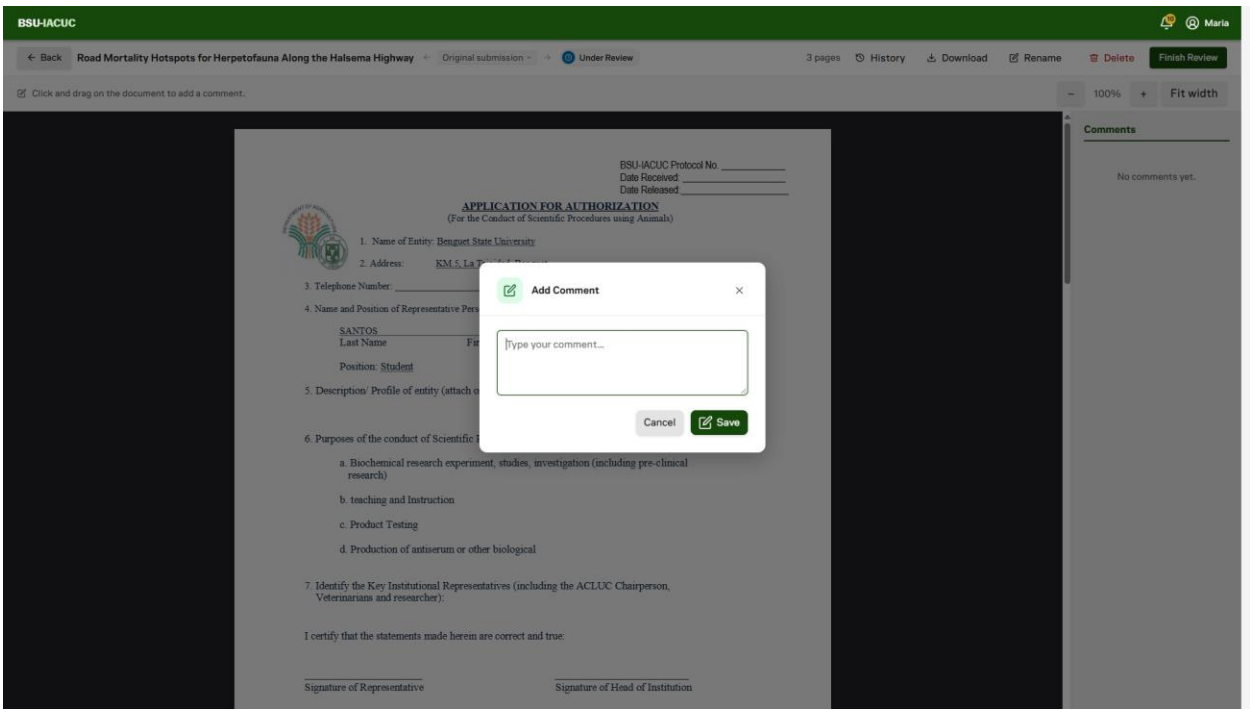
Adding a comment

1. Click and drag on the document to draw a box around the part you want to comment on. On a touch screen, tap and drag.
2. In the Add Comment window, type your comment.
3. Press Save.

The box stays on the page with a number, and the comment appears in the Comments panel with its page number, your name and the date. On a small screen, tap a box to read its comment in a pop-up.

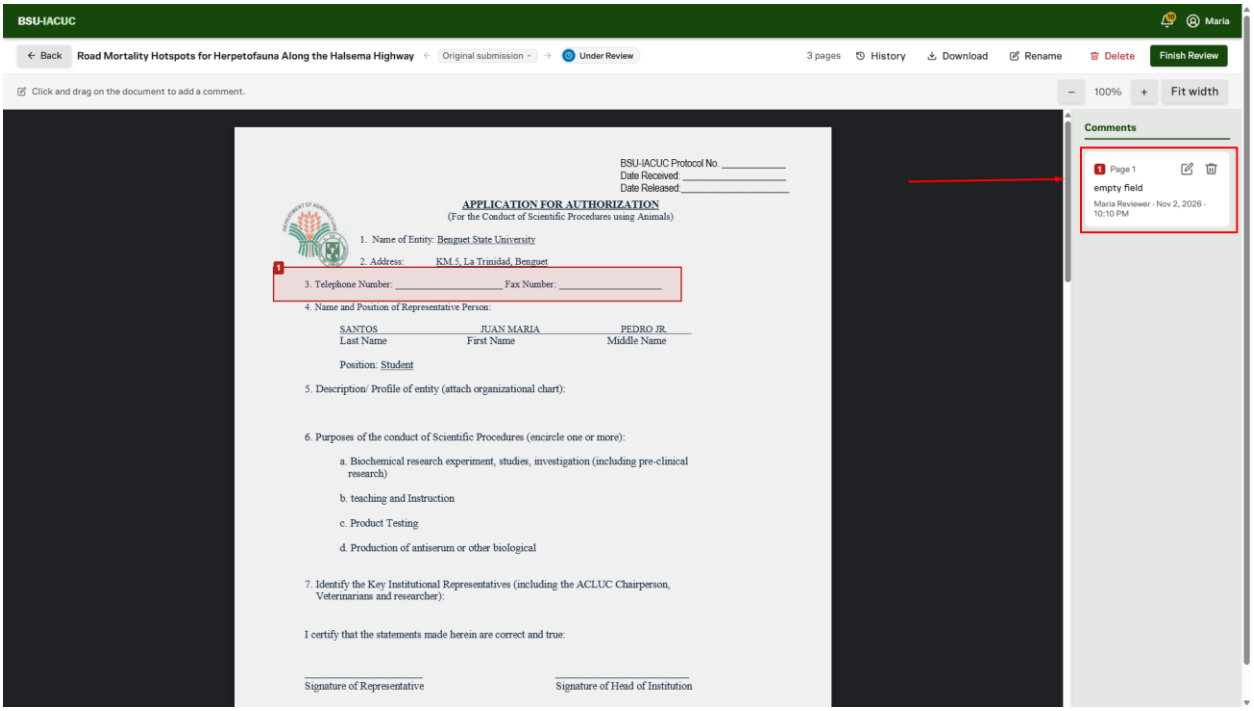
Draw one box for each issue so that the researcher can find it easily. Comments are saved the moment you press Save, so you can stop at any time.





Editing and deleting comments

In the Comments panel, press the pencil icon to edit a comment, or the trash icon to delete it. Deleting asks you to confirm and cannot be undone. You can edit only the comments you wrote. Comments can be changed only while the protocol is under review and you are on its latest version.

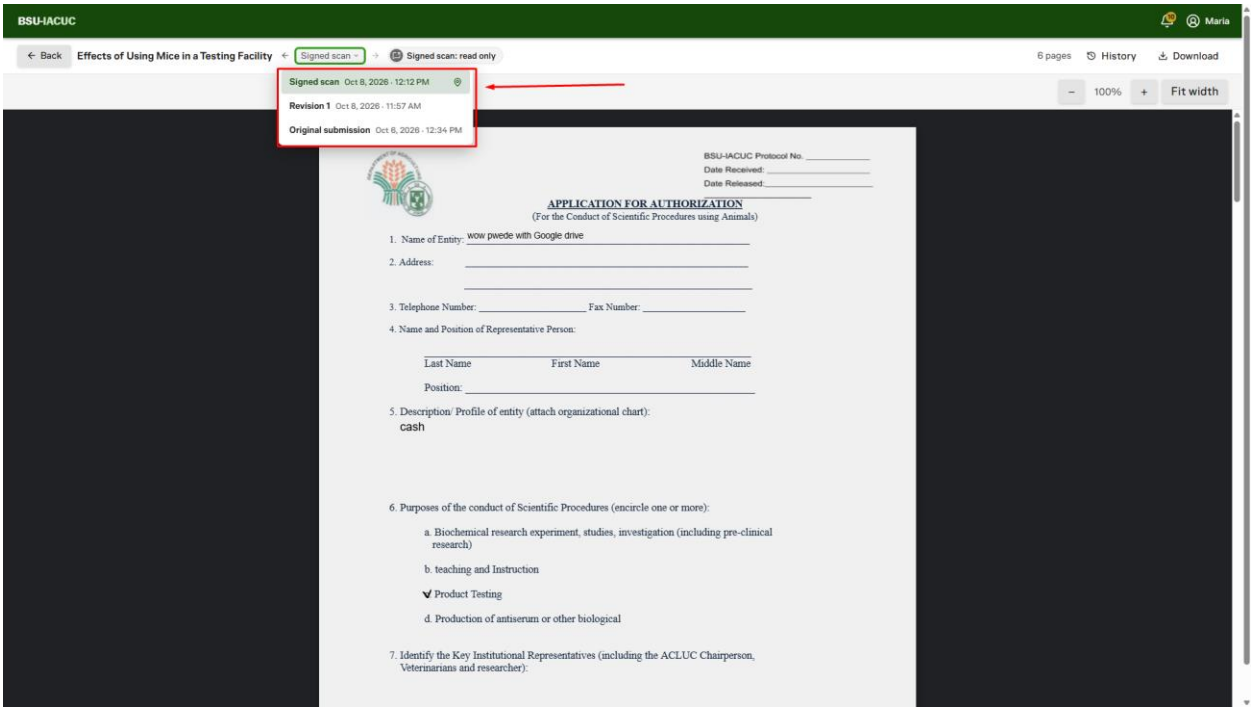


Zooming

Use the minus and plus buttons above the document to zoom out and in, or press Fit width to fit the page to your screen. On a touch screen, zoom back to Fit width before drawing a new comment box.

Switching versions

Each time the researcher resubmits, a new version is added. Use the arrows beside the version label to move between versions, or press the label to see the list with dates. Older versions open with their comments, so you can check that your earlier comments were addressed, but you can comment only on the latest version.

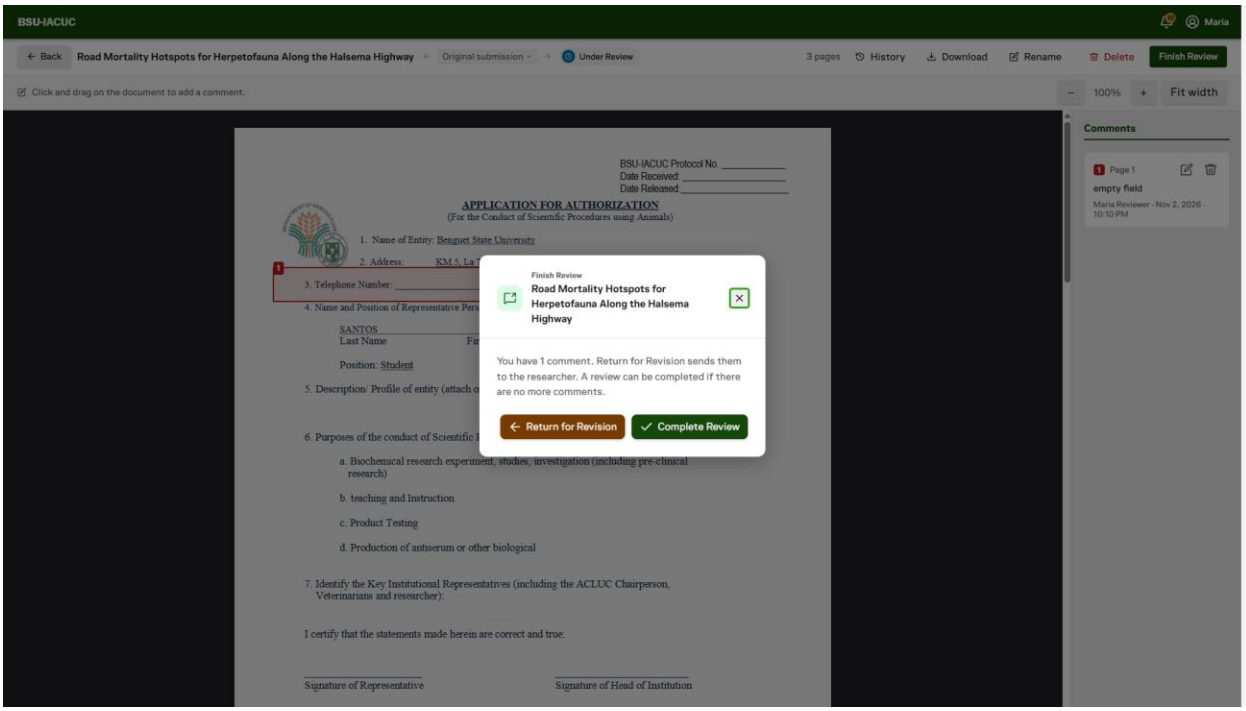


Leaving and resuming

Your comments are saved as you add them. Press Back and confirm Leave to return to the Dashboard. When you come back, press Review again and your comments are still there, so you can finish later.

X. Finishing a review

When you have read the whole protocol, press Finish Review at the top right. A window shows how many comments you have and offers two choices. If the training certificate is not verified yet, a message explains that it has to be verified first, and you can come back later.

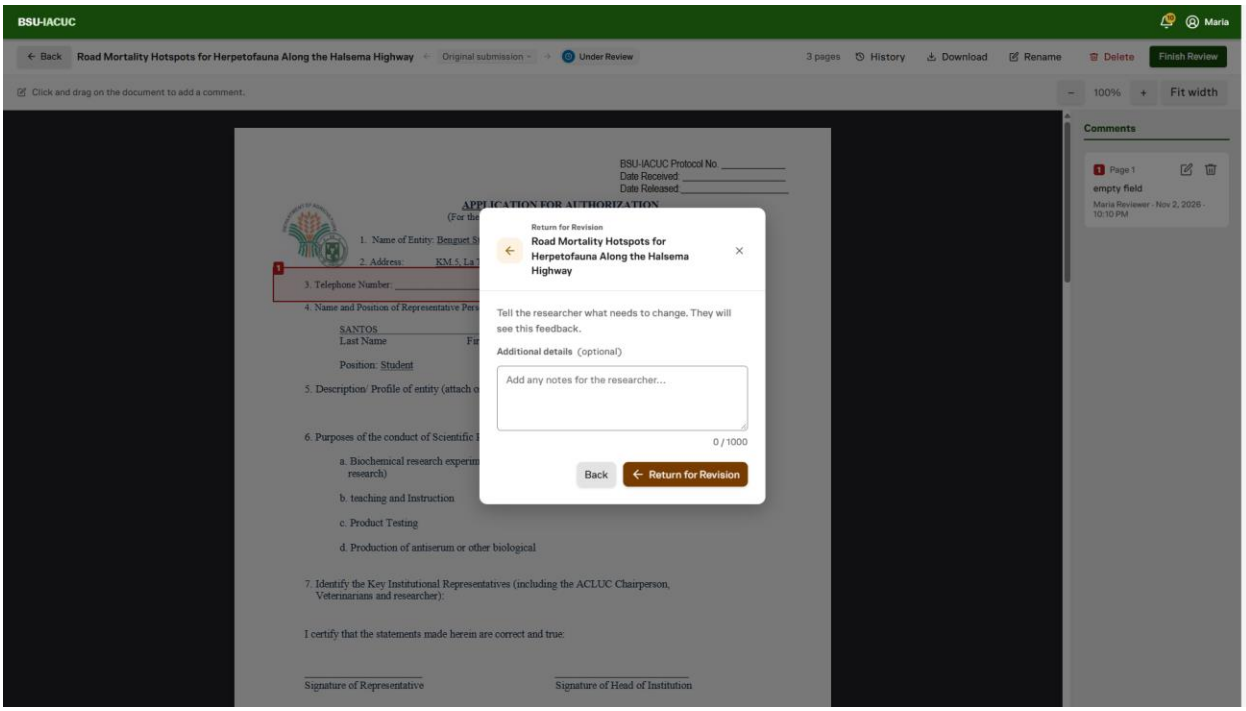


Returning for revision

Choose this when the protocol has issues for the researcher to fix.

1. Press Finish Review, then Return for Revision.
2. Optionally, write a note of up to 1000 characters telling the researcher what needs to change. The researcher sees it on the protocol card beside your comments.
3. Press Return for Revision, then confirm.

The protocol moves to Returned for Revision and you are taken back to the Dashboard. The researcher is notified in the portal and by email, and your comments become visible to them only after the protocol has been returned.



Completing the review

Choose this when the protocol passes review.

1. Make sure no comments remain. Complete Review is refused while comments exist, because comments are meant to be addressed by the researcher. Delete the comments that no longer apply, or return the protocol for revision instead.
2. Press Finish Review, then Complete Review.
3. Press Proceed to confirm.

The protocol moves to Reviewed, and a record for it is created automatically in Records. Administrative staff take it from here, and you are not asked to do anything else for this protocol.

When the researcher resubmits

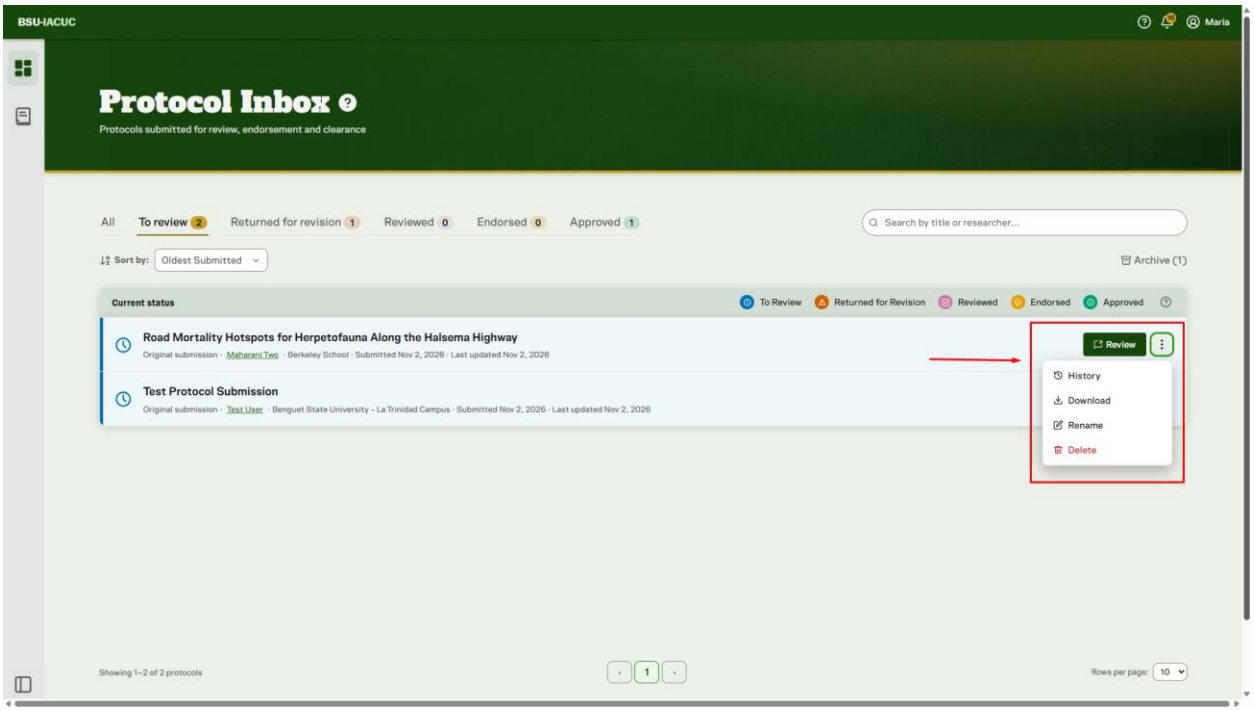
You are notified when a researcher resubmits a protocol. It returns to To Review as a new version, and the round shown on its card goes up. Open it, switch to the earlier version if you want to check your previous comments against the changes, and finish the review again.

XI. The three-dot menu

The three-dot button on each card, and the More button inside the viewer, open a menu. Only the items that apply to the protocol appear.

Item	*When it is available*	*What it does*
History	Always	Shows every submitted version, payment records and earlier titles
Download	When a file is on record	Downloads the latest file

Rename	To Review and Returned for Revision	Changes the protocol title
Amendments	After the researcher has submitted one	Lists the amendments
Delete	To Review, Returned for Revision and Reviewed	Deletes the protocol
Undo Reviewed	Reviewed, until payment is verified	Sends the protocol back to To Review



Renaming a protocol

Use Rename to correct a protocol title. Titles must be unique. The researcher is notified of the new title, and the earlier title stays in History.

Deleting a protocol

Reviewers delete a protocol directly, with no approval needed, after a confirmation. A protocol that has been endorsed or approved cannot be deleted. If a researcher asks to delete a protocol themselves, the request goes to administrative staff, and a note in the viewer tells you that a request is pending.

Undoing a review

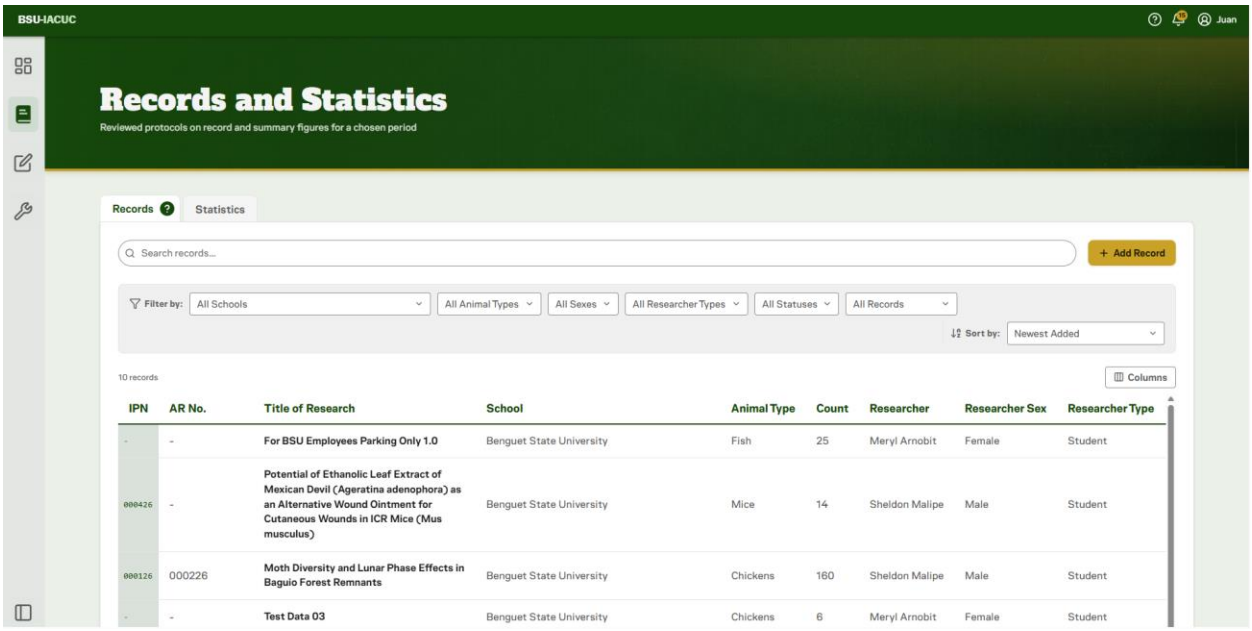
If you marked a protocol as Reviewed by mistake, press Undo Reviewed. The protocol goes back to To Review, and the record created for it is removed. This is no longer possible once payment has been verified. Administrative staff must undo the payment first.

Amendments

An amendment is a change a researcher sends after their clearance was issued. Amendments are not reviewed again, so there is nothing for you to do. You can read them from Amendments in the menu.

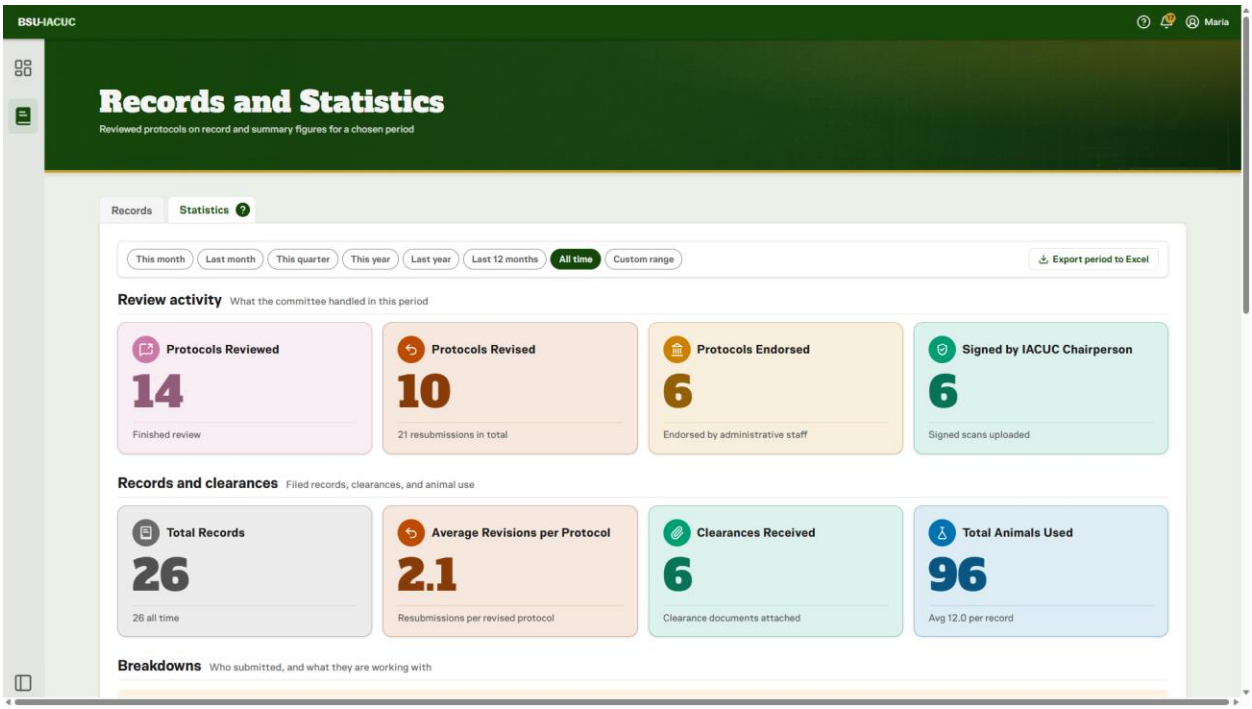
XII. Records and statistics

Records lists every protocol record. A record is added automatically when you mark a protocol as Reviewed. Reviewers can read records but cannot add, edit or delete them.



- Search finds records by what you type.
- Filters narrow the table by school, animal type, sex, researcher type, status, or Needs Completion. Sort changes the order, and so does pressing a column heading. A third press on the same heading resets the order.
- Columns lets you hide the columns you do not use. Your choice is remembered on this computer, and Show all columns brings them back.
- The eye icon on a row opens all the details of that record, including a link to the protocol file.

Open the Statistics tab for totals and charts over a period you choose, including a custom date range. The cards count protocols reviewed, revised, endorsed and signed, along with records, average revisions, clearances received and animals used. Press Export period to Excel to download the statistics and every record in the period.



XIII. Notifications and email

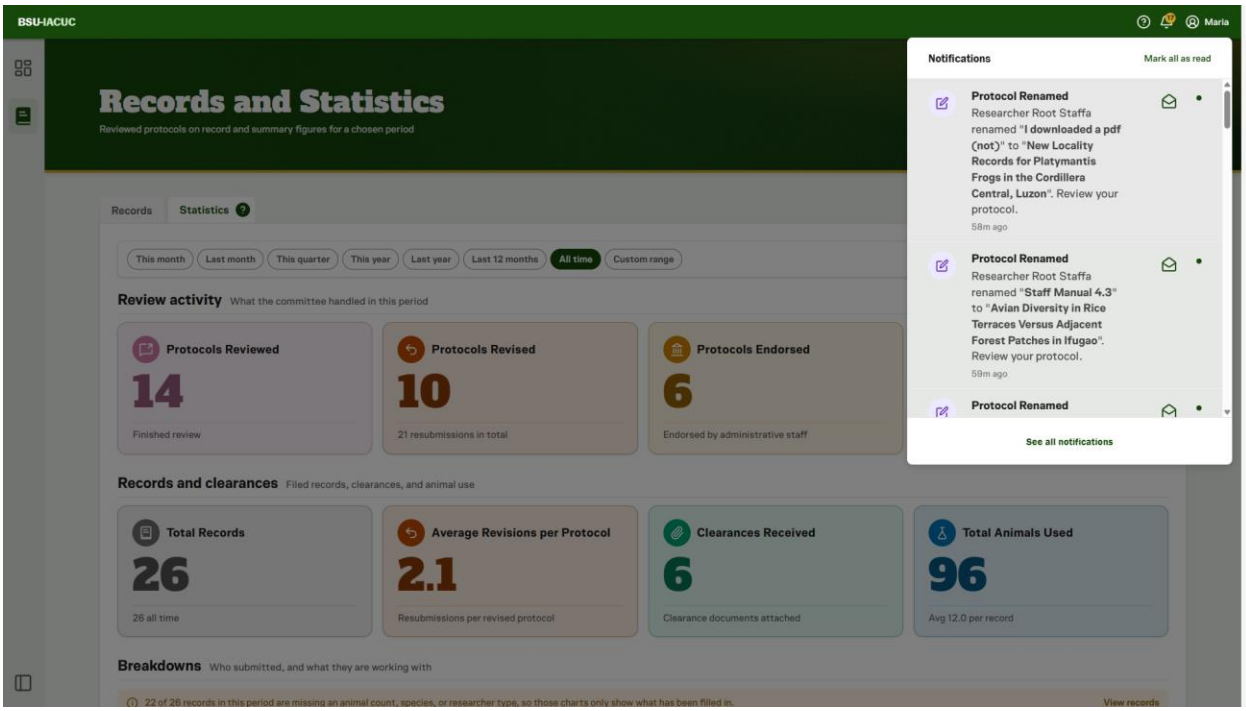
The bell in the top bar shows a badge when there is something new. Press it to see the latest items, or choose See all notifications for the full list with page controls. Mark all as read clears the badge. Each notification says what happened and what, if anything, you need to do next.

As a reviewer, you are notified when:

- A new protocol is submitted. Open it to start the review.
- A researcher submits for the first time. Open it to verify their training certificate, then start the review.
- A researcher resubmits a protocol. Open it to review the revisions.
- A training certificate needs to be verified.

The portal also sends these updates by email. You can turn email updates on or off from My Account, or from the manage preferences link at the bottom of any email. Turning emails off does not stop in-portal notifications.

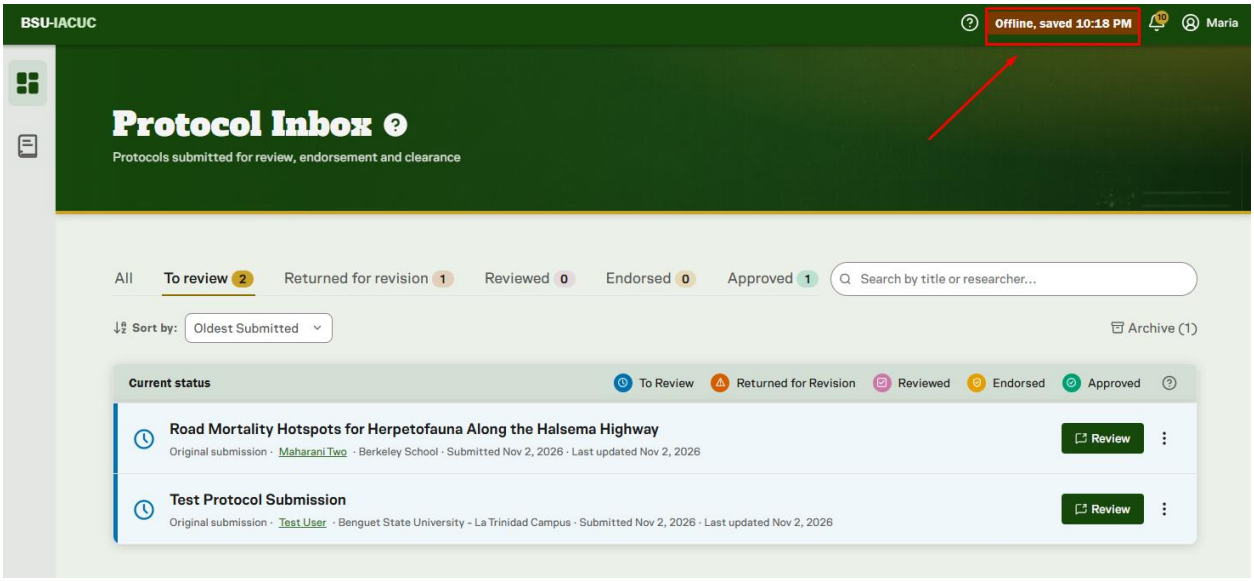
If the page shows a message that says new activity was detected, press it to refresh.



Working with a weak connection

If your connection drops, an Offline tag appears beside the logo. Actions you take while offline, such as comments, are saved on your device and sent automatically when the connection returns. A banner shows what is waiting, and comments that have not been sent are marked Pending sync. Keep the page open until it finishes. You cannot finish a review or return a protocol while comments are still waiting to sync.

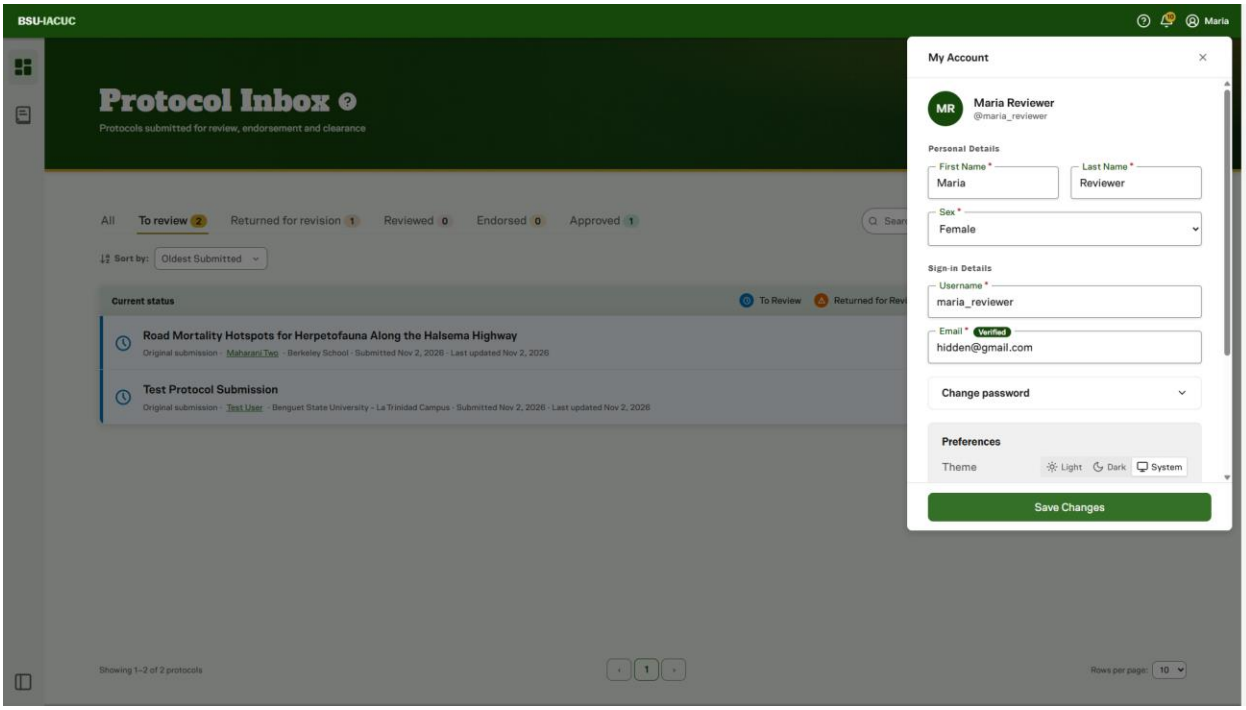
If a protocol changed on the server while you were offline, the banner asks you to choose for each waiting action. Keep mine tries your action again. Keep theirs drops your action and leaves the server as it is. Discard all drops every waiting action.



XIV. My Account

Open My Account from the top bar. Here you can:

- Update your name, username and email.
- Send yourself a new verification link if your email is not verified.
- Change your password.
- Choose light, dark or system theme.
- Turn email notifications on or off.
- Preview the public site.
- Delete your account.



Deleting your account

Press Delete account and enter your password to confirm. Deletion cannot be undone.

XV. Troubleshooting

Problem	*What to try*
The invitation link does not work	Invitation links expire after 48 hours. Ask administrative staff for a new one
Cannot log in, and the portal says approval is pending	Administrative staff have not approved your application yet. Wait for the email, or contact CCARD
Cannot log in after several tries	Wait 15 minutes, or use Forgot Password
The portal says the account is deactivated	Ask CCARD administrative staff to reactivate it

Finish Review does not work	The researcher's training certificate has to be verified first. Verify it, or wait for the researcher to resubmit it
Complete Review is refused	Comments still exist on the protocol. Delete the ones that no longer apply, or return the protocol for revision
Cannot add a comment	Comments can be added only on the latest version of a protocol that is under review. On a touch screen, press Fit width first
Undo Reviewed is missing	Payment has already been verified. Ask administrative staff to undo the payment first
Comments show Pending sync	You are offline. Keep the page open until the connection returns
Signed out unexpectedly	The portal signs out after 30 minutes without activity. Log in again

XVI. Getting help

For questions about the IACUC, protocols or clearances, email ccard@bsu.edu.ph or use the Contact Us page, which lists every office, with address, phone, email and website. For problems with your account or role, contact CCARD administrative staff. For problems with the portal itself, the Home page FAQ lists who to contact.

XVII. Glossary

Term	*Meaning*
IACUC	Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee. Reviews research that uses live animals
CCARD	Cordillera Center for Animal Research and Development, Benguet State University
Protocol	The written plan for a researcher's animal work, on the official IACUC form
Reviewer	CCARD personnel who read submitted protocols, comment on them, and mark them as reviewed or return them for revision
Administrative staff	CCARD personnel who handle every step after the review, and who manage accounts and site content
Training certificate	The IACUC training certificate a researcher submits with their first protocol
Comment	A box drawn on a protocol document with a note for the researcher
Round	The submission number of a protocol: the first submission, then each resubmission
IPN	The reference number administrative staff assign to a protocol before it is endorsed
Animal research clearance	The document issued through the BAI that allows a researcher's animal work to start
BAI	Bureau of Animal Industry
DA-RFO-CAR	Department of Agriculture, Regional Field Office, Cordillera Administrative Region

Amendment	A change to a protocol after its clearance was issued